is, a presidential government, you will have to resign.'[75] On the other hand, a Gallup poll in early May showed an *improvement* in JFK's rating: eighty-two per cent now approved of their president (up ten per cent).[76]

In the immediate aftermath of the fiasco, Kennedy appointed General Maxwell Taylor to lead a special commission to review the operation. Taylor had a distinguished wartime record, and after retiring as army chief of staff wrote a book highly critical of Eisenhower's overreliance on nuclear weapons, and which argued for a strategy based on 'flexible response.' *The Uncertain Trumpet* accorded with JFK's views and agendas.[77] The remit of Taylor's group (which included Allen Dulles, Robert Kennedy and Arleigh Burke) extended across paramilitary and military activities that fell short of war. It reflected and reinforced the President's preferences, which were to inform his decision later that year to expand the commitment of US military advisers in South Vietnam. The Taylor report provided a more nuanced evaluation of the Bay of Pigs (which unsurprisingly fell short of indicting JFK). Taylor himself was soon appointed as Military Adviser to the President and on 1 October 1962 he became the Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, where he played a central role in the missile crisis.

In the aftermath of the debacle, Kennedy spoke of 'throwing the CIA to the winds', and even considered installing his brother as Director of Central Intelligence. Instead, he replaced Dulles with John McCone, a Republican with extensive experience of government under Truman and Eisenhower. McCone was to play an intriguing part in the missile crisis. He was alone in the upper reaches of the agency in believing that Khrushchev intended to deploy nuclear missiles in Cuba and disagreed with Langley's analysts who believed otherwise.

Robert Kennedy had played a marginal role in the unfolding catastrophe of Operation Zapata. His immediate reaction to its failure was to counsel belligerence (as it was during the missile crisis in October 1962): 'The time has come for a showdown for in a year or two years the situation will be vastly worse. If we don't want Russia to set up missile bases in Cuba, we had better decide what we are willing to do to stop it.'[78] The President's anger (and self-recrimination) translated into an immediate desire to act, and he ordered the Joint Chiefs of Staff to prepare an invasion plan. By the